

Metropolis1-DT -- Metropolis Pt. 1, The Miracle and the Sleeper

by Dream Theater

Images and Words, 1992. Est. ~130 BPM.

John Myung's bass here is aggressive and technical -- locked tight to the double-kick riff, present enough to cut through two guitars and keyboards without turning to mush. That's a different problem than a pocket groove: this part needs bite and definition first, low end second.

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

NAM: Darkglass Alpha Omega (Distortion side)

Darkglass Alpha Omega (Alpha Side) -> Aguilar DB 751 amplifier -> Darkglass DG412ES cabinet -> Shure SM7B microphone. Slot 62.

The Alpha side is the more controlled, saturated distortion voicing of the Alpha Omega -- modern metal bass grind without the fuzz side's wooliness. That's exactly the character this riff needs: aggressive but still articulate.

AMP and CAB are off -- the NAM replaces both.

- Gain: 70 -- real distortion, not edge-of-breakup. This riff is meant to hit hard.
- VOL: 75
- Bass: 60 -- enough low end to matter, not so much it swallows the attack.
- Middle: 55 -- kept present so the part reads as a note under the guitars, not just rumble.
- Treble: 65 -- pushed for pick/finger definition on the fast unison passages.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 30. High-gain NAM at this setting picks up noise between hits -- tightens the low end so the riff stops cleanly instead of smearing.

PRE -- Micro Boost, on CTL.

Gain: 45 when engaged.

Off for the quieter intro/interlude passages, on for the driving main riff and instrumental unison sections -- same amp tone throughout, just pushed harder up front when the song calls for it.

DST -- off.

The Alpha Omega capture already carries the drive. A second gain stage would just compress the attack instead of adding character.

AMP / CAB -- off. Replaced by the NAM.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: 0, 120Hz: -3, 400Hz: -6, 800Hz: +8, 4.5kHz: +10.

A dip around 400Hz keeps the tone from getting boxy under two guitars; the push at 800Hz and 4.5kHz is where

the riff's attack and definition live.

MOD -- off. No modulation -- this part needs to sit dead center and hit like a hammer, not shimmer.

DLY -- off. Straight, driving part. No delay.

RVB -- Room, on CTL, inverted relative to PRE.

Mix: 35, Decay: 45, Trail: true.

On for the quieter intro/interlude passages -- a little ambiance to open the space up when the band thins out.

Off for the driving main riff -- dry and dead center so it hits as hard as possible.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: PRE (Micro Boost) and RVB (Room), inverted against each other.

- **CTL off** -- the resting state the patch loads into. Quieter intro/interlude sound: no boost, room reverb engaged for a little air.
- **CTL on** -- driving main riff and instrumental unison sections. Boost engaged, room reverb drops out, dry and locked dead center with the kick.

Engage CTL going into the main riff, back off for the interludes. Same amp tone throughout -- this is a dynamics switch, not a tone change.